A-A-54536
31 December 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

RETRACTOR, EYELID, NONMAGNETIC, DESMARRES, 5-1/2 INCH

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-R-36687(1) which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers one type of nonmagnetic eyelid retractor.

Salient characteristics:

General. The eyelid retractor shall be 5-1/2 inches in length, of the DeSmarres design, and suitable for use in aiding in the removal of foreign bodies from the eye.

Material. The eyelid retractor shall be fabricated from class 3, type 316 austenitic (nonmagnetic) stainless steel in accordance with ASTM F899. As an alternate, the handle may be fabricated of brass that is nickel and chromium plated.

Hardness. The eyelid retractor shall have a Rockwell Hardness of B75 to B85 when tested in accordance with ASTM E18 or E92 whichever is applicable. Conversion of hardness values shall be done in accordance with ASTM E140.

Style, design and dimensions. The eyelid retractor shall be in accordance with Figures 1, 2 and 3 for style, design and dimensions.

Nonmagnetic Performance. The eyelid retractor shall show no magnetic response when an Alnico No. 5 alloy horseshoe-shaped magnet weighing 0.140 ± 0.005 pounds and capable of supporting 43 cubic inches of steel weighing 12 ± 1/2 pounds is used to approach and make contact with the surface of the eyelid retractor.

Finish. The eyelid retractor shall have a mirror or satin finish.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Passivation. The eyelid retractor shall be properly passivated.

Corrosion resistance. The eyelid retractor shall no evidence of corrosion or plating of copper when tested for corrosion resistance in accordance with ASTM F1089.

Identification marking and labeling. The eyelid retractor shall be legibly marked with the contractor's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless". Foreign manufactured eyelid retractors shall bear the name of the country of origin.

Workmanship. The eyelid retractor shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One eyelid retractor, as specified, constitutes one unit.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as specified herein. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one eyelid retractor. Sampling shall be Inspection level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 1.0.

Examination. Examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one eyelid retractor. Sampling shall be Inspection level S-2 with an AQL of 1.0.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more text characteristics.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerance specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	Item Identification
6515-00-360-7900	RETRACTOR, EYELID, Nonmagnetic, Desmarres, 5-1/2 Inch.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

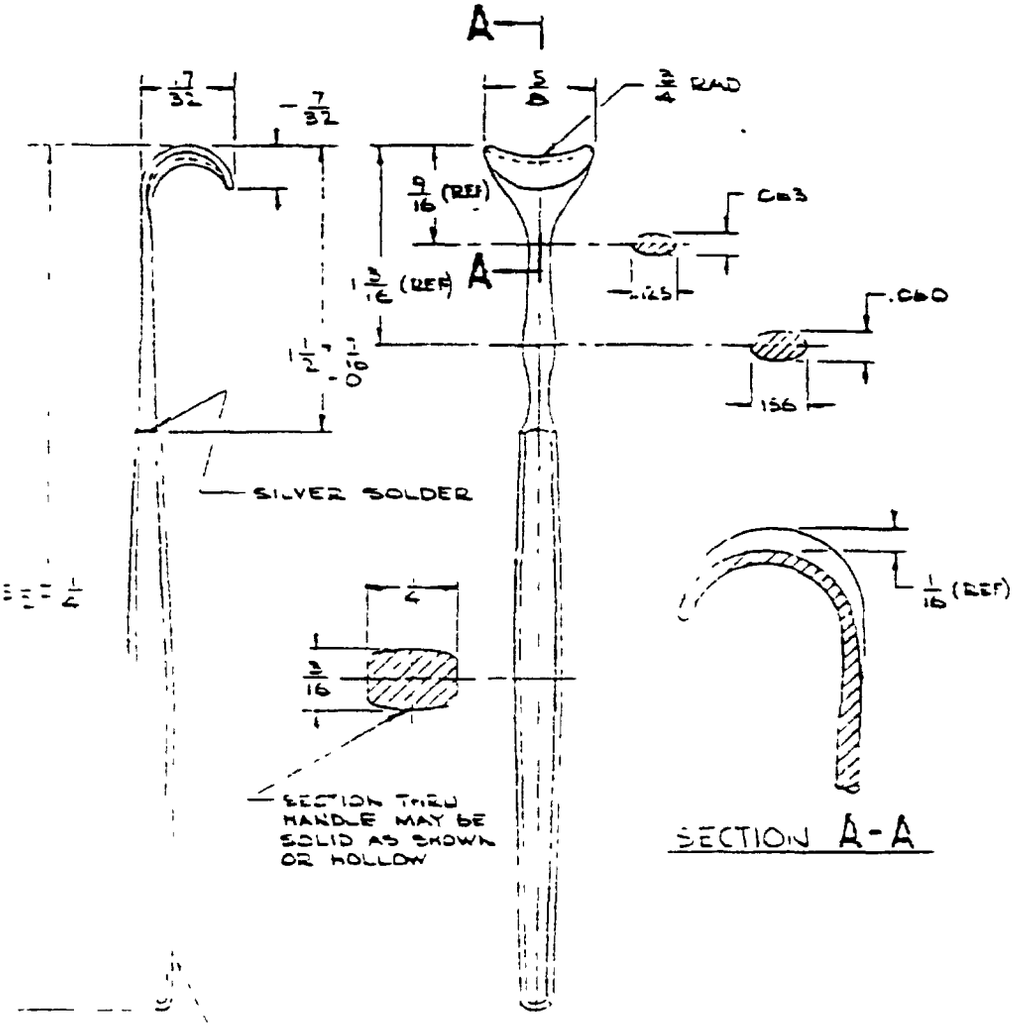
VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC: 45556

Project No. 6515-5217

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

A-A-54536



— HANDLE NICKEL CHROME PLATED BRASS

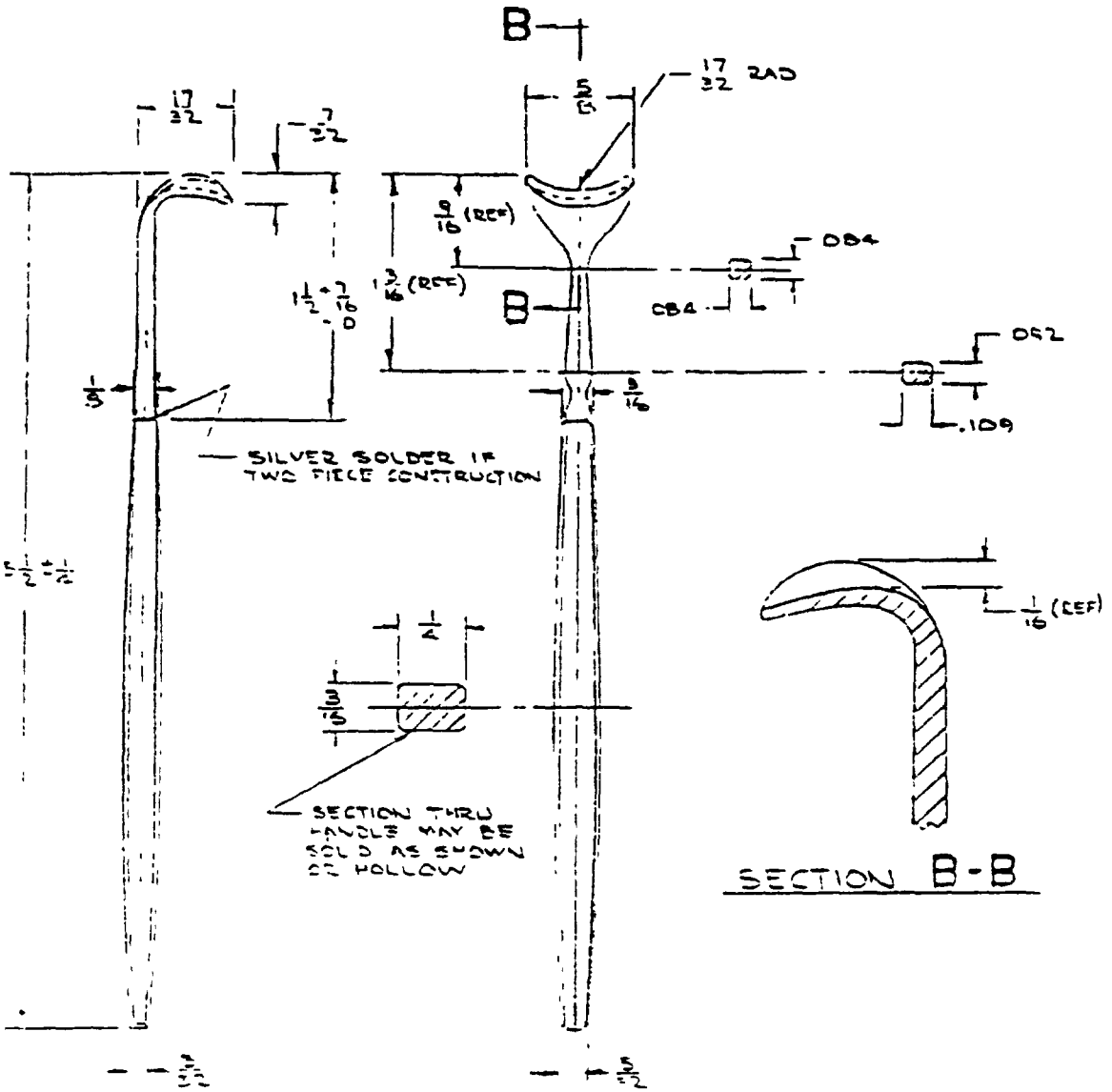
UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES		
TOLERANCES ON		
FRACTIONS	DECIMALS	ANGLES
± 1/32	± .007	±

NSN 5515-00-360-7900

NOTE
HANDLE AS WELL AS BLADE END TO BE NON-MAGNETIC.

FIGURE 1 RETRACTOR, EYELID, NONMAGNETIC, DESMARRES, 5-1/2 IN.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



MAY BE OF ONE OR TWO PIECE CONSTRUCTION STAINLESS STEEL THROUGHOUT.

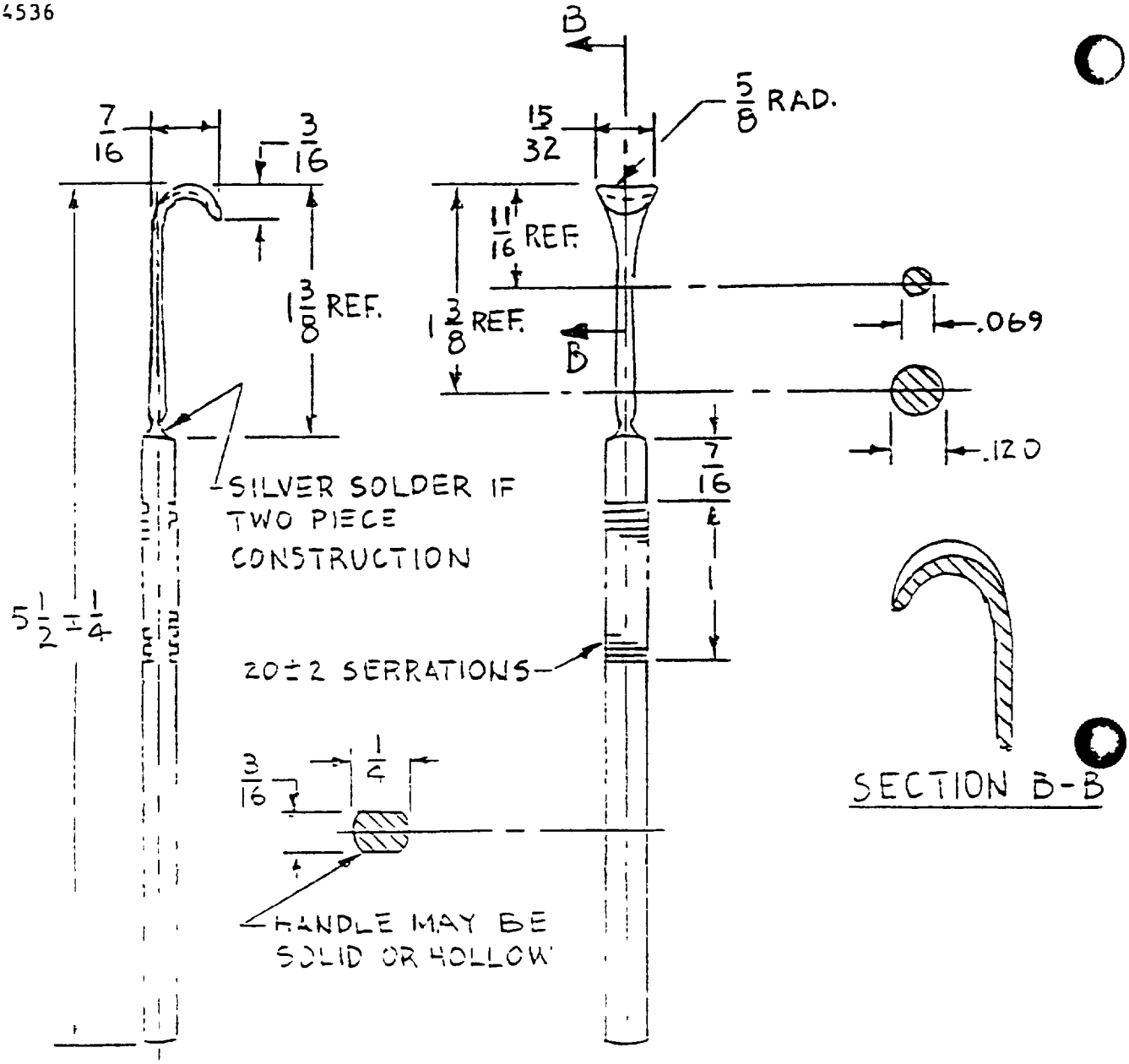
NSN 6515-00-360-7900

NOTE
HANDLE AS WELL AS BLADE END TO BE NON-MAGNETIC.
FIGURE 2, ALTERNATE RETRACTOR ACCEPTABLE WITH BLADE END AS SHOWN IN FIGURE 1.

UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES		
TOLERANCES ON		
FRACTIONS	DECIMALS	ANGLES
± 1/32	± .007	±

FIGURE 2. RETRACTOR, EYELID, NONMAGNETIC, DESMARRES, 5-1/2 IN. (ALTERNATE 1)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



MAY BE OF ONE OR TWO PIECE CONSTRUCTION, STAINLESS STEEL THROUGHOUT.

NSN 6515-00-360-7900

NOTE:
HANDLE AS WELL AS BLADE END TO BE NON-MAGNETIC.

FIGURE 3, ALTERNATE RETRACTOR ACCEPTABLE WITH BLADE END AS SHOWN IN FIGURE 1.

UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES		
TOLERANCES ON FRACTIONS ± 1/32	DECIMALS ± .007	ANGLES ±

FIGURE 3. RETRACTOR, EYELID, NONMAGNETIC, DESMARRES, 5-1/2 IN. (ALTERNATE 2)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-54536	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 31 December 1991

3 DOCUMENT TITLE
RETRACTOR, EYELID, NONMAGNETIC, DESMARRES, 5-1/2 INCH

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (*Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.*)

5 REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)

7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8 PREPARING ACTIVITY

a NAME	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)
Defense Personnel Support Center	(1) Commercial (215) 737-2870 (2) AUTOVON 444-2870
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) ATTN: MSE 2800 S. 20th Street Philadelphia, PA 19145	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.